SME Energy Burden Dashboard Report Summary

This report analyzes electricity costs for small and medium enterprises (SMEs) across selected African countries using tariff data. The dashboard evaluates the energy burden, defined as the proportion of monthly revenue spent on electricity, and compares grid electricity costs with projected solar alternatives over time.

The analysis shows that energy burden varies significantly across countries, primarily driven by differences in tariff rates. Countries with higher tariffs, such as Kenya, exhibit a noticeably higher percentage of revenue allocated to electricity costs, while countries with lower tariffs, such as Nigeria, show a relatively lower burden. This highlights the financial strain that energy costs place on SMEs depending on geographic location.

The dashboard also compares grid electricity costs with projected solar costs over time. The results indicate that while grid tariffs are gradually increasing, solar alternatives remain relatively stable and potentially more cost-effective in the long term. This suggests that transitioning to solar energy could significantly reduce operational expenses for SMEs.

Overall, the findings demonstrate that electricity costs are a critical factor affecting SME profitability. The dashboard provides a clear, data-driven foundation for evaluating energy strategies and supports the case for renewable energy adoption where feasible. Future improvements could include incorporating more granular revenue data and expanding the model to cover additional countries and tariff scenarios.